BREAKING NEWS

Two Miami twenty-somethings won $298M to arm Afghanistan’s army

Tonight: War Dogs (2016). A business deal, or organized crime?

Group 6 · Department of Criminology, University of Dhaka · Submitted to Md. Rezaul Karim Shohag, Assistant Professor

MINHAZ AHAMED KHAN NABIN
ANCHOR · THE CRIMINOLOGY DESK

Six reporters, one story, one question

RUNNING ORDER

00:00	**Headlines and rundown**	Minhaz Ahamed Khan Nabin · The criminology desk
01:40	**Profile and explainer: who they are, how they won**	Jesmin Naher Sweety · Miami
03:20	**Live from Tirana; following the money**	Md. Abir Mahmud Jakaria · Tirana
05:00	**Exclusive: the boxes; expert panel**	Imran Mridha · Investigations editor
06:40	**Court report; studio analysis**	Ahnaf Akif · Legal and crime analyst
08:20	**Fact check; the final word**	Nishit Kumer · Fact-check desk

ABOUT THE FILM

FILM

War Dogs (2016)

DIRECTOR

Todd Phillips

STARRING

Jonah Hill, Miles Teller, Ana de Armas, Bradley Cooper

BASED ON

Guy Lawson's Rolling Stone article (2011) and book (2015)

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ANCHOR · THE CRIMINOLOGY DESK

Who are the “War Dogs”?

THE RECRUIT

David Packouz

- Massage therapist in Miami Beach
- Broke, with a baby on the way
- Hides the job from his partner

THE HUSTLER

Efraim Diveroli

- David’s childhood friend; runs AEY
- Bids for Pentagon contracts online
- Learned the trade through his uncle

CRIMINOLOGY DESK ANALYSIS

Strain and institutional anomie
Merton (1938); Messner & Rosenfeld (1994)

Wealth is the goal, legal means are blocked, so David “innovates”. Money starts to outrank family.

Differential association
Sutherland (1947)

Crime is learned in close groups: David learns the methods and the excuses from Efraim.

JESMIN NAHER SWEETY
CORRESPONDENT · MIAMI

How two young men beat the defence giants

1

The Pentagon
posts its tenders publicly online

2

AEY bids
on the small orders the giants skip

3

AEY wins
by underbidding the big firms

4

AEY delivers
whatever it takes: even driving pistols from Jordan into Iraq

CRIMINOLOGY DESK ANALYSIS

Rational choice
Cornish & Clarke (1986)

A calculated gamble: high reward, risks judged worth taking. Each success invites a bigger one.

Enterprise model
Smith (1980)

Legal and illegal business sit on one spectrum, shaped by the same market. AEY drifts into the grey.

JESMIN NAHER SWEETY
CORRESPONDENT · MIAMI

The stockpile, and the broker who cannot sell it himself

DATELINE: TIRANA, ALBANIA

~100 million

rounds of old ammunition sitting in Albanian state depots

Henry Girard

Arms dealer on a US terrorist watch list. He cannot sell to the US himself, so he needs AEY as a clean American front.

A composite character, inspired by the real broker Heinrich Thomet (Lawson, 2015).

MD. ABIR MAHMUD JAKARIA
FOREIGN CORRESPONDENT · TIRANA

CRIMINOLOGY DESK ANALYSIS

Network model and brokerage

Morselli (2009)

Brokers hold power by linking worlds that cannot reach each other: the Pentagon and Balkan stockpiles.

Patron–client model

Albini (1971)

Henry trades access to supply for a share of the profit, using AEY's clean name.

Every link in the chain takes a cut

US Army
pays the contract price

AEY
keeps its margin

Henry
takes a broker's share

Officials and middlemen
control access to the depots

CRIMINOLOGY DESK · KLITGAARD (1988)

C = M + D − A

M monopoly: Henry and the depot officials control access
D discretion: officials and fixers decide who gets in
A accountability: weak in wartime
C corruption: abuse of entrusted power for private gain (Transparency International, n.d.)

RELATED

March 2008: blast at the Gërdec ammunition depot near Tirana kills 26; senior officials are charged.

Real context the film leaves out (Al Jazeera, 2008).

MD. ABIR MAHMUD JAKARIA
FOREIGN CORRESPONDENT · TIRANA

Chinese ammunition, repacked to look Albanian

BEFORE

Old crates, Chinese markings

Decades-old rounds, banned by a US embargo and by the contract

REPACK

AFTER

Plain cardboard boxes

Markings removed; delivered to the Army as Albanian

White-collar crime and fraud

Sutherland (1940)

Crime by respectable people in the course of their work: hiding the origin to keep a $298M contract. Documented in the real case (Lawson, 2015).

IMRAN MRIDHA
INVESTIGATIONS EDITOR

SOUNDBITES · SYKES & MATZA (1957)

"The troops still get bullets that work."
DENIAL OF INJURY

"The government buys from shady sources too."
CONDEMNING THE CONDEMNERS

"We didn't write the rules; we just filled the order."
DENIAL OF RESPONSIBILITY

Soundbites are our paraphrases, not film quotes.

Is AEY organized crime?

EXPERT 1: YES UNTOC, Article 2 (UNODC, 2004)

- ✓ A structured group of 3+ persons
- ✓ Exists over a period of time
- ✓ Commits serious crime (fraud)
- ✓ For financial benefit
- ✓ Crosses five countries

VS

EXPERT 2: NO Abadinsky's attributes (2013)

- ✗ No hierarchy of ranks
- ✗ No exclusive membership
- ✗ No code, rules or rituals
- ✗ Did not survive its leaders' arrest
- ✗ Not the mafia

PANEL VERDICT: both are right. Organized crime by law, but not by stereotype.

IMRAN MRIDHA
INVESTIGATIONS EDITOR

How it ended, and how to classify it

2007 — $298M Army contract awarded to AEY

2008 — Press exposé: decades-old Chinese ammunition

2008 — Army suspends AEY; the founders are indicted

2011 — Efraim: 4 years in prison. David: 7 months of house arrest

CRIMINOLOGY DESK · CLASSIFICATION

Organized white-collar crime
Sutherland (1940)

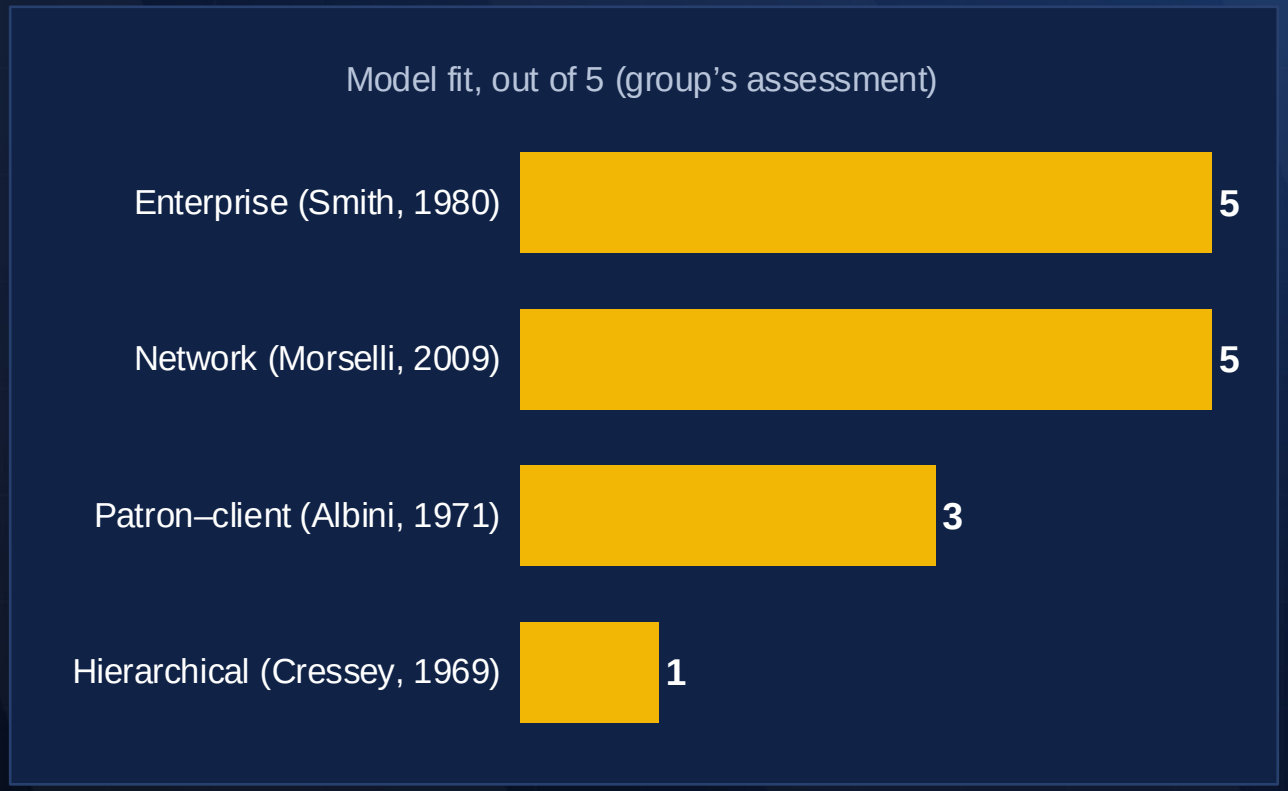
Committed by businessmen, through a business, in the course of their work.

State–corporate crime
Kramer, Michalowski & Kauzlarich (2002)

The state outsourced war supplies to the lowest bidder and checked too little.

AHNAF AKIF
LEGAL AND CRIME ANALYST

Which model of organized crime fits AEY?



5/5 **Enterprise**
A business answering market demand, sliding from legal to illegal.

5/5 **Network**
Brokers like Henry link the Pentagon to Balkan stockpiles.

3/5 **Patron–client**
Henry trades access for a share, but no lasting patron.

1/5 **Hierarchical**
No ranks, no code, no family. Not the mafia.

AHNAF AKIF
LEGAL AND CRIME ANALYST

How accurate is War Dogs?

AEY won a $298M Army contract	TRUE	Documented by Lawson (2015)
Chinese ammunition was repacked to hide its origin	TRUE	The core of the real fraud case
Efraim got 4 years; David got house arrest	TRUE	Matches the real sentences
Henry Girard was a real dealer	COMPOSITE	Inspired by broker Heinrich Thomet
It was mostly a wild adventure	MISLEADING	Comedy glamorizes the money; blames two men, not the system
The film shows who got hurt	LEFT OUT	Soldiers and taxpayers barely appear

NISHIT KUMER
FACT-CHECK DESK

> ***They were not a mafia family. They were a business, and the system let them in.***

THE ANSWER

Organized crime under the UN definition, but not the mafia: organized white-collar crime, explained by the enterprise and network models.

THE LESSON FOR BANGLADESH

Large public projects rely on contractors and middlemen too. Checking real owners and where goods come from is crime prevention.

Thank you. *Questions?*

NISHIT KUMER
FACT-CHECK DESK